

What Users Are Actually Facing

A deep dive across every production data source — what real users try to do, where the app stops them, and what to fix first.

July 30, 2026 · 8 parallel analyses · every table + live App Store reviews

45/wk

NEW REAL SIGNUPS
— 3x GROWTH IN 3
WEEKS

88%

OF REAL USERS
USE THE APP
EXACTLY ONE DAY

35%

OF REAL SEARCHES
RETURN ZERO
JOBS

1

USER HAS
COMPLETED THE
FULL JOURNEY —
AND LOVED IT

WHO IS COUNTED. Every number in this report covers **genuine strangers only (~119 real users)**. Excluded: samrishi24@gmail.com, cvapplyrtest@gmail.com, rishi.samadhiya@outlook.com (a founder account the old filter missed — the analysis caught it), ~15 hidden ats***@example.com test accounts, and the zsellr tester accounts. Founder & test activity is reported nowhere in these figures.

01 • The one-line story

Growth is real and accelerating — and almost all of it drains out on day one.

STAGE OF THE JOURNEY	REAL USERS	%
Registered an account	134	100%
Touched their profile at all	39	29%
Uploaded a résumé	37	28%
Ran a job search	16	14%
Opened an application page	7	5%
Confirmed a completed application	0–2	~1%
Paid money	0	0%

- **90 of 102** real users (since telemetry began) have exactly **one active day**. Day-1 return: **7.8%**. Nobody has four or more active days.
- Weekly actives $\approx$ that week's signups — the bucket fills exactly as fast as it leaks.
- Activation is **now-or-never**: median time from signup to résumé upload is **2.3 minutes**. Whoever isn't converted in the first session never comes back to do it later.

THE BRIGHT SPOT

When someone reaches the payoff, the product delivers. Both organic App Store reviews (5★) praise exactly the intended magic — *"It saved a lot of my time... especially Cover Letter"* — and the one user who completed the full loop came back two more days and did it again. The value is real; the path to it is blocked by five walls.

02 · The five walls

Each wall is measured, not guessed — with users' exact words and actions.

1 The search box speaks a different language than its users

13 of 20 real search inputs weren't URLs. People type what they'd type into Google — and the app turns it into a fake web address and tries to scan it:

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https://plulmbing · https:// finance · https://pakistan · https://paint ·  
https://amazon · https://ems companies · https://tcz (typo for TCS) — one user even  
pasted her own employment-letter PDF from her phone.
```

Actual inputs typed by real users into the employer search

- **35% of real searches returned zero jobs** — five of the seven zero cases are exactly this mismatch.
- Users forgive one failure (they retry a typo once), then leave. **No real user has ever searched in two different weeks.**
- No real search since June returned more than 20 jobs — even successes look thin.

Expectation: a job search engine — type a company, an industry, a country, get jobs. **Reality:** a career-page URL scanner.

2 The job feed has nothing where users live

FEED SUPPLY (135,928 JOBS)	REAL USERS (LOCATABLE)
US 29.9% · Sweden 29.0% · "Global" 24.0%	India ~43% · Pakistan · Sri Lanka · Philippines · UAE · Ghana · Nepal · Lebanon...
India: 1,584 jobs (1.2%)	10 user home countries: 0 jobs in the feed
#1 field: IT & Software (22.7%)	Demand: plumber, painter, sales, quoting specialist, EMS, government

- 81 real users browsed the feed → only 10 ever opened a job (**12%**). **Zero** have ever saved a feed job.
- They look, find nothing near them, and leave — quietly.
- Bonus finding: the Switzerland & Germany feed ingesters have been **silent ~2 weeks** (97% of CH jobs stale).

3

The welcome credits buy exactly one attempt

Prices: search 3–5 credits · cover letter 1 · download 2. Welcome gift: **5 credits**.

- The observed pattern is mechanical: one search (3) + 1–2 letters (1 each) → **stranded at 1–2 credits, below every single price** — including the 2-credit download.
- **Only 1 real cover-letter download has ever happened.** Users generate letters they cannot take with them.
- 26 real users (20%) sit below the cheapest search price; 8 are at zero.
- When spending stops, usage stops **the same day**. Nobody has ever returned to top up.
- **Real revenue: \$0.** The only genuine checkout ever started (Starter, ₹4.99) was abandoned mid-payment.
- Some users paid a credit for letters addressed to "*Ambitious Estate Agent (Employer Name Not Provided)*" — paying for a placeholder.

4

Failures are silent — in both directions

- **76% of job-match scores were never computed** — those jobs show **0% match**. Six users saw 0% on every job. Among computed scores the median is 30%. The app's core promise mostly displays zeros.
- 2 users' résumés are **stuck in a parse error** — they uploaded a file, believe they're set up, and silently get degraded results.
- One user tapped "generate cover letter" **3 times in 5 seconds** — no letter was ever created, no error shown, nothing logged.
- An application was almost certainly **submitted but never detected** — a user completed a 15-question form (answers were harvested) with no completion recorded.
- Autofill picked **State = "Alabama"** on a US-only dropdown for a user in **Bengaluru** — selects need a "no confident match → leave blank" guard.

FIXES USERS NEVER HEAR ABOUT

The self-heal loop genuinely works — both real "this search failed" reports (Revolut, Rover) were fixed within a day. But there is no "your search is fixed" notification: one user stayed active for two days after her fix landed and **never knew**. The repair was wasted.

We can't hear them, and we can barely reach them

- **Support conversations: 0. Words of negative feedback, ever: 0.** Every churned user left silently.
- Push notifications reach **47%** of real users — and **0% of real Android users** (they're on builds older than the Firebase fix).
- In-app notification read rate: **6%**. The inbox is not a channel.
- **~36%** of tracked users are stranded on old app versions — before Auto Fill, the fast Job Hub, and the guide.
- **74% of devices open the app and never register.** Android devices open the app *more* than iOS (294 vs 230) yet signed-in users are 73 iOS : 12 Android — Android users hit the signup wall and bounce.
- At the front door: 5 users tried to **log in before having an account**, failed, then found signup — and **4 more never made it in at all**.

SECURITY SIDE-FINDING

The public demo account has taken **446 login attempts from 48 different IPs** (ongoing credential-stuffing). Rotate or disable it, and add per-IP login rate-limiting.

03 · What users expect — in their own actions

EXPECTATION	THE EVIDENCE
"Type anything, get jobs"	Keywords, brands, industries, countries, typos — 13/20 inputs
Jobs near them	South Asia / MEA / Africa users browsing a US-Sweden feed, 12% open rate
Non-tech roles matter	Plumber, painter, sales, quoting specialist, EMS, government searches
Value in the first 5 minutes	Median signup→résumé 2.3 min; 74% browse without registering
Paste anything & it works	Job links, Google share-links, even a personal PDF
Honest numbers	A wall of 0% match scores reads as "this app doesn't work for me"

04 · The fix plan, ranked by impact

Each fix maps to a measured wall. At ~45 signups/week, every one of these is A/B-measurable within a week of shipping.

	FIX	WALL IT REMOVES
P0	Make the search box a real search box. Detect what was typed (keyword / brand / industry / country / URL / job link), route keywords to the feed + live Google search, tolerate typos. Never build <code>https://plulmbing</code> again.	#1 — 35% zero results
P0	Local jobs for the real user base. India first (43% of users, 1.2% of supply), then Pakistan, Sri Lanka, Philippines, MEA. Default the feed to the user's country.	#2 — empty feed
P0	Let the first loop finish. Welcome credits that cover search + letter + download (or first download free); a top-up prompt at the stranded moment; track every "not enough credits" hit.	#3 — one-shot economics
P1	Kill the silent failures. Never show 0% for unscored matches; visible retry for résumé parse errors; surface cover-letter failures; assume-submitted when a full form was filled; "your search is fixed" push.	#4
P1	Autofill select-guard. No confident match → leave the dropdown alone (the Alabama/Bengaluru case).	#4
P2	Open the front door. Browse-before-signup (74% bounce, Android worst); "New here? Create account" prominent on login; update-nudge banner for the 36% on old builds.	#5
P2	See clearly next time. Track last-seen, all screens, zero-result / credit-wall / letter-failure events, login-failure identities.	Measurement
P2	Security. Disable/rotate the demo account; rate-limit logins per IP.	Side-finding

Honest caveats

- Event telemetry begins late June — ~32 earlier users are invisible to behavioral analysis.
- User-country sample is 37 of ~119 (the rest gave no address).
- Some "silences" are measurement gaps, not behavior — the P2 instrumentation fixes them for the next report.

THE VERDICT

CVApplyr's promise lands whenever a user actually reaches it. Between install and that moment stand five measured walls — the search box, local supply, first-loop credits, silent failures, and reach. Growth is accelerating into those walls at 45 users a week. Fix the first three, in order, and the retention curve is the scoreboard.